

II - V - I IN MAJOR KEYS

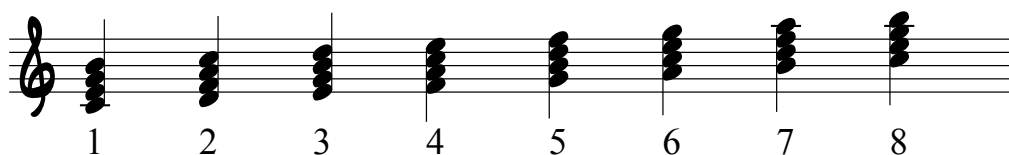
FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #48

The ii - V - I is a big deal in many kinds of music, and very especially in jazz. Learning how to hear and play this progression is hugely important. Here we'll figure out some of the "whys" behind the progression, which will help us in upcoming video #49 on Minor ii - V - i progressions. Our goal is to understand them, be able to explain them, and then most importantly, to be able to clearly play them.

- 1 In a major key, we use the major scale as our "baseline" tonality. We could use other scales, like lydian, but traditionally we use major (ionian).



- 2 If we build diatonic 7th chords ("in the key of") off each note in the scale, we get this -



- 3 Now, we analyse them to find out what chords we've written down.



- 4 So, this is why the "ii" chord is usually minor, the "V" chord usually dominant, and the "I" chord usually major. The "baseline" tonality (in this case, major), defines the quality of all the other chords.

